

FFAS

HANDBOOK

Leave Administration and Alternative Work Schedules

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For FAS, FSA, and RMA Offices

SHORT REFERENCE

17-PM
(Revision 2)

UNITED STATES DEPARTMENT OF AGRICULTURE
Farm Service Agency
Washington, DC 20250

Table of Contents

Page No.

Part 1 General Information

1	Overview	1-1
2	Responsibilities	1-2
3	Official Work and Core Hours	1-6
4	Holidays and Office Closures	1-7
5	General Leave Information	1-11
6	Work Schedule Logs and T&A's	1-12
7	Requesting and Notifying Supervisor of Leave	1-13
8	Family Related Leave	1-14
9	Involuntary Leave	1-15
10-30	(Reserved)	

Part 2 Work Schedules

31	General Work Schedule Policy	2-1
32	Work Schedule Responsibilities	2-4
33	Establishing Work Schedules, Keeping Daily Work Logs, and Requesting Leave	2-6
34	Work Schedule Descriptions.....	2-11
35	Holiday Entitlements and Options	2-18
36	Timekeeper Actions.....	2-19
37	Non Full-Time Employees.....	2-20
38-50	(Reserved)	

Part 3 Annual Leave

51	Full-Time Employees	3-1
52	90 Calendar Day Appointments	3-2
53	Part-Time Employees	3-3
54	Other Leave Categories	3-5
55	Granting Earned Annual Leave	3-5
56	Advanced Annual Leave	3-6
57	Requesting and Reporting Annual Leave	3-7
58	Lump-Sum Annual Leave	3-8
59	Terminal Annual Leave	3-8
60	Annual Leave Ceilings	3-9
61	Overseas Ceilings	3-10
62	SES and SFS Ceilings	3-11
63	Restoring Forfeited Annual Leave	3-13
64	Restoration Because of Administrative Error	3-13
65	Restoration Because of Employee Illness	3-15
66	Restoration Because of Exigency of Public Business	3-16
67-80	(Reserved)	

Table of Contents (Continued)

Page No.

Part 4 Sick Leave

81	Full-Time Employees	4-1
82	Part-Time Employees	4-3
83	Earned Sick Leave	4-5
84	Advanced Sick Leave	4-6
85	Requesting and Reporting Sick Leave	4-8
86-110	(Reserved)	

Part 5 Nonpay Status Leave

111	Unpaid Leave	5-1
112	LWOP	5-1
113	AWOL	5-4
114	Military and Civilian Furlough	5-5
115-135	(Reserved)	

Part 6 Military Leave

136	Regular Military Leave	6-1
137	Requesting and Using Military Leave	6-4
138	Emergency Military Leave	6-5
139	Administrative Claims for Leave Because of the Decision in the Butterbaugh v Department of Justice Case, 336F.3d 1332 (Fed. Cir. 2003).....	6-6
140-160	(Reserved)	

Part 7 Excused Absence

161	Granting Excused Absences	7-1
162	Excused Absence for Official Time	7-4
163	Excused Absence for Voting	7-4
164	Excused Absence for Participation in Military Funerals	7-5
165	Discretionary Excused Absences	7-6
166	Excused Absence for Court Leave	7-9
167	Witness Service	7-9
168	Court Fees or Payments	7-10
169	Participation in Emergency Rescue or Protective Work.....	7-11
170	Change of Official Duty Station	7-12
171	Physical Examinations for Military Duty	7-13
172	Draft Registration.....	7-13
173-190	(Reserved)	

Part 8 (Reserved)

191-210	(Reserved)	
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7 Requesting and Notifying Supervisor of Leave

A Requesting Leave

***--All** requests for leave shall be made on OPM-71 (Exhibit 6), except for:--*

- holidays
- excused absence granted by OPM or Executive Order
- AWOL.

***--No** leave shall be approved by e-mail; however, FAXed OPM-71's are acceptable.--*

Employees may request leave in increments of 15 minutes. **All** leave **must** be requested and approved **before** use, except for emergencies.

B Approving OPM-71's

An employee's immediate supervisor or someone acting for the supervisor shall approve or disapprove OPM-71's.

C Who to Notify When Absent

Employees, or someone acting on their behalf, shall notify their immediate supervisor, designee, or office head, as early as possible on the first day of absence when they are unable to report to their official worksite as scheduled. They **must** continue to call in **each workday** until they return, unless they are excused from work for a specific period of time.

***--Note:** CED's shall notify their DD.--*

D Supporting Leave Documentation

Employees shall submit documents supporting leave for:

- advanced sick leave
- court leave
- jury duty
- military leave
- organ or bone-marrow donation
- sick leave for adoption.

Supervisors have the discretionary authority to request medical documentation for absences * * * because of illness or injury.

*--Part 2 Work Schedules

31 General Work Schedule Policy

A Work Schedule Options

There are 4 work schedule options, as follows:

- CWS 5/4/9 and 4/10 that are **fixed**
- maxiflex that is flexible
- standard (also called flexitour) that is **fixed**
- variable day (also called gliding) that is flexible.

Note: The variable day (gliding) work schedule is **not** available for FSA State and County Office employees.

B Daily Workhours

Daily workhours are those hours during which an employee **must** establish their work schedule. This applies to **all** FFAS work schedule options.

Policy: Established daily workhours shall begin and end according to the following table, Monday through Friday. For an employee working a flexible work schedule, their daily workhours begin upon arrival at work, unless on approved leave.

Agency/Office	Begin Time	End Time
All FAS	6:30 a.m.	7:30 p.m.
FSA National Office and All RMA	6 a.m.	6:30 p.m.
FSA Kansas City, State, and County Offices	6 a.m.	6 p.m.

--*

--31 General Work Schedule Policy (Continued)*C Official Office Hours**

Official office hours are those hours during which FFAS services shall be available to the public.

Policy: Official office hours shall be 8 a.m. to 4:30 p.m., Monday through Friday, unless otherwise decided by an office director or equivalent; such as FAS, RMA, or FSA National Office Division Director, an SED for FSA State Offices, or STC based on recommendations from County Office manager.

Note: Using flexible work schedules should enable some offices to extend their customer service hours; that is, open earlier than or stay open later than these hours.

D Core Hours

Core hours are those daily hours during which a **full-time** employee **must** be at work, on lunch break, using credit hours (employees on flexible work schedules **only**) or on approved leave, except for nonworkdays.

Policy: Core hours:

- **shall be according to the following table** that allows for a 6-hour minimum workday
- do **not** apply to part-time employees, unless they are **required** to work core hours
- include a 30-minute **unpaid** lunch break.

Agency/Office	Core Hours
All FAS.	9:30 a.m. to 3:30 p.m.
All RMA and FSA, except Kansas City.	9 a.m. to 3:30 p.m.
FSA, Kansas City.	9:30 a.m. to 2:30 p.m.

--*

Part 3 Annual Leave

51 Full-Time Employees

A Annual Leave Accruals

Full-time employees accrue annual leave after completing their first **full** biweekly pay period.

The number of annual leave hours earned biweekly depends on the employee's years of qualified Federal or CO service. The following is an annual leave accrual table for a full-time employee.

Annual Leave Category	IF a full-time employee has...	THEN they accrue...
4	less than 3 years of service	4 hours of annual leave each pay period.
6	at least 3 years of service, but less than 15 years	6 hours of annual leave each pay period. Also, these employees accrue 10 hours during the last biweekly pay period before the end of the calendar year.
8	15 years or more of service	8 hours of annual leave each pay period.

***--Note:** SES, SFS, and senior level employees accrue 8 hours of annual leave each full biweekly pay period regardless of their length of their service with the Federal Government.--*

B Partial Pay Period

Employees do **not** accrue annual leave when either of the following occurs:

- a new employee's EOD date falls in the **middle of the pay period**

Exception: When EOD is Sunday and the first Monday of the pay period is:

- a holiday
- the new employee's scheduled nonworkday.

- an employee retires or resigns in the **middle of the pay period**.

Exception: When the effective date is the last Friday of the pay period and that day is:

- a holiday
- the employee's scheduled nonworkday.

Note: Effective December 8, 1998, employees in CO positions shall follow Federal accrual regulations.

51 Full-Time Employees (Continued)

C Employee Transfer

Full-time leave-earning employees transferring **without** a break in service to another Federal or CO position will keep their current annual leave balance and continue to accrue annual leave, as usual.

D Loss of Accrual

Full-time leave-earning employees do **not** earn annual leave in a pay period where their cumulative balance of nonpay status leave hours equals or exceeds 80 hours or any 80-hour increments thereafter. This rule is termed “the 80-hour rule” and does **not** apply to part-time employees.

See paragraph 111 for information about unpaid leave.

52 90 Calendar Day Appointments

A 90 Calendar Day Appointment Leave Earning

Employees with a 90 calendar day appointment or less are **not** entitled to earn annual leave. See paragraph 81 for sick leave entitlement.

B 90 Calendar Day Appointment Extensions

Employees with 90 calendar day appointments that are granted extensions beyond the *--90 calendar days without a break in service, or are converted to a permanent appointment without a break in service, **must** retroactively be credited with annual leave that would--* have been earned from the date of initial appointment to the date of the appointment extension. Employees will continue to earn annual leave biweekly from the appointment extension date.

*--C Appointments Over 90 Calendar Days

Employees, with appointments over 90 calendar days, earn annual leave starting at the beginning of the first full pay period of their appointment.--*

53 Part-Time Employees

A

Part-Time Annual Leave Accruals

Annual leave accruals for a part-time employee are based on **pay status hours** reported for the pay period. Nonpay status leave hours, such as LWOP, are not used in computing accruals for a part-time employee. The following table estimates the approximate annual leave accrued by a part-time employee each pay period, but the table does not reflect part-time carryover hours.

Annual Leave Category	IF a part-time employee has...	THEN they accrue 1 hour for every...
4	less than 3 years of service	20 hours in pay status.
6	at least 3 years of service, but less than 15 years	13 hours in pay status.
8	15 years or more of service	10 hours in pay status.

B

Disregard Pay Status Hours Over 80

When calculating leave accruals for a part-time employee, disregard any pay status hours exceeding 80 for the pay period. Pay status hours over 80 are **not** carried forward or used in any subsequent accrual computations.

C

Part-Time Carryover Hours

Part-time carryover hours or unapplied hours are those pay status hours remaining after the computation of the annual leave accrual for the current pay period. These unapplied hours are automatically carried forward, added, and used in calculating accruals for the next pay period.

D

Employee Converting From Part-Time to Full-Time

--An employee who converts from a part-time to a full-time position forfeits any unused part-time carryover or unapplied hours to their credit.--

Part 4 Sick Leave

81 Full-Time Employees

A Sick Leave Accrual

*--Full-time leave-earning employees **and** temporary full-time employees with a limited appointment **accrue 4 hours** of sick leave for each **80-hour** biweekly pay period they work or take leave.

Note: When a new employee's EOD date falls on the first Sunday of the pay period and the following day is a holiday or scheduled nonworkday, then the employee is entitled to accrue sick leave for the pay period.

B Accrual Exceptions

Full-time employees do **not** accrue sick leave when:

- a new employee is unable to complete an 80-hour pay period because of their EOD date falling in the **middle of the pay period**
- an 80-hour increment of unpaid leave is reached in the current pay period

Note: See subparagraph 111 B for more information.

- an employee retires or resigns in the middle of the pay period and does not complete their biweekly requirement of 80 hours
- an employee has an intermittent appointment.--*

Note: Effective December 8, 1998, employees in CO positions shall follow Federal accrual regulations.

81 Full-Time Employees (Continued)

C Recredit of Sick Leave

5 CFR 630.502 states that when an employee transfers between positions within the same leave system or to a position in a different leave system, **without a break in service**, the agency from which the employee is transferring shall certify the employee's sick leave balance on the date of transfer and the receiving agency shall recredit the employee's sick leave balance. See Exhibit 2 for definitions of same leave system and different leave system. Also see 5 U.S.C 6312 for reference to FSA (former ASCS) employees.

If a **break in service** occurs, an employee is entitled to a recredit of sick leave without regard to the date of their separation, **if** the employee is re-employed on or after December 2, 1994, and **if the employee returns to the leave system** in which their previous sick leave was earned.

***--Examples:** If employees move from CO position to GS position, or vice versa, they are **not** entitled to sick leave recredit because CO and GS positions are **not** in the same leave system. However, if employees move from CO position to CO position or from GS position to GS position, they are entitled to sick leave recredit because they have remained in the same leave system.--*

Exception: If the employee was re-employed into government service **before** December 2, 1994, and forfeited their previous sick leave balance based on the 3-year sick leave rule, the sick leave remains forfeited.

All sick leave recredits **must** be supported by written documentation acceptable to the agency. A copy of this documentation shall be kept in the employee's official personnel folder.

D Cumulative Sick Leave

Earned sick leave accumulates without limit or ceiling. At the end of the leave year, all accumulated sick leave is carried forward into the next leave year.

E Loss of Accrual

Full-time leave-earning employees do **not** earn sick leave in a pay period where their cumulative balance of nonpay status leave hours equals or exceeds 80 hours or any 80-hour increments thereafter. This rule is termed "the 80-hour rule" and does **not** apply to part-time employees. See paragraph 111 for information about unpaid leave.

82 Part-Time Employees**A Sick Leave Accruals**

Sick leave accruals for part-time employees are based on their hours in pay status each pay period. One hour of sick leave accrues for every 20 hours in pay status reported for the pay period.

B Part-Time Carryover Hours

Part-time carryover hours or unapplied hours are those pay status hours remaining after computing the sick leave accrual for the current pay period. These unapplied hours are automatically carried forward, added, and used in calculating accruals for the next pay period.

An employee who converts from a part-time to a full-time position in the middle of the pay period forfeits any part-time carryover or unapplied hours to their credit.

C Disregard Pay Status Hours Over 80

When calculating accruals for a part-time employee, disregard any pay status hours exceeding 80 for the pay period.

***--D Recredit of Sick Leave**

If a break in service occurs, an employee is entitled to sick leave recredit regardless of the date of their separation, if the employee:

- is re-employed on or **after** December 2, 1994
- returns to the leave system in which their previous sick leave was earned.

See subparagraph 81 C for examples.--*

Using AD-1046, Leave Transfer Program - Recipient Application (Continued)

C
Example of
AD-1046

This is an example of a completed AD-1046.

REPRODUCE LOCALLY. Include form number and date on reproductions.

LEAVE TRANSFER PROGRAM - RECIPIENT APPLICATION						FOR PERSONNEL USE ONLY: CASE NUMBER KC 9X-01	
INSTRUCTIONS: Use this form to apply to be a leave recipient under P.L. 100-566. Attach to this form a brief description of the nature and severity of the medical emergency and appropriate documentation of the medical emergency; a physician's certificate, the medical prognosis and anticipated duration of the condition. After completing this form, forward through your supervisor to the office in your agency designated to approve leave recipients. Approval as a leave recipient does not guarantee that leave will be donated. Donor employees will designate the recipient of their leave.							
PART I - APPLICATION AND CERTIFICATION (To be completed by the applicant or another employee on his or her behalf)							
1. NAME OF RECIPIENT (Last, First, Middle Initial)		2. POSITION TITLE		3. SOCIAL SECURITY NUMBER			
Moon, Johanna K.		Clerk-Typist		111-333-2222			
4. SERIES, GRADE OR PAY LEVEL		5. DUTY STATION		6. ORGANIZATIONAL TITLE (Agency, Division, Branch Section)			
GS-322-3		Kansas City, MO		FSA, PD, HRB, COS			
7. OFFICE ADDRESS		8. OFFICE TELEPHONE NO.		9. HOME TELEPHONE NO.			
Room 321, 1234 Independ. St. Kansas City, MO 12345-1234		814-447-4666		814-690-4765			
10. NAME OF TIMEKEEPER		11. TELEPHONE NO. OF TIMEKEEPER		12. OFFICE ADDRESS OF TIMEKEEPER			
Jessie M. Wade		814-447-3641		Room 321, 1234 Independ. St. Kansas City, MO 12345-1234			
13. T&A CONTACT POINT NO.		14. ANTICIPATED OR ACTUAL DURATION OF MEDICAL EMERGENCY (If known)		15. DATES LEAVE EXHAUSTED		16. AMOUNT OF DONATED LEAVE REQUESTED (hours, days or months)	
		Beginning Date: 5/7/9X Ending Date: 6/1/9X		Annual: 5/8/9X Sick (if applicable): 5/7/9X		132 hours	
17. PLEASE INDICATE HOW YOU PREFER THE ANNUAL LEAVE DONATED TO BE APPLIED BY NUMBERING THE FOLLOWING IN ORDER OF YOUR PREFERENCE. (Donated annual leave may be applied to retroactively replace leave without pay and/or advanced sick or annual leave in connection with this medical emergency.)							
1. For current use		4. against advanced annual leave		3. against advanced sick leave		2. against LWOP	
18. I agree to have my (please specify)		case number only		case number, and circumstances only		X name, case number and circumstances	
published for the purpose of receiving donations. If I agree to have my circumstances published, the following 5 lines or less describing my medical emergency will be published exactly as I write it and will be published exactly as I write made available to employees of my agency who wish to make donations to me.							
I was informed by my physician on April 30, that I will have to undergo surgery on May 6 due to an ongoing medical problem which has to be corrected.							
CERTIFICATION (If certifying on behalf of another employee, modify as appropriate.)							
I certify that (1) I have been affected by the medical emergency described in the attachment since the date indicated above, (2) I have or will have exhausted all annual leave and any available sick leave that could otherwise be used as of date indicated above, and (3) expect to be absent from duty without paid leave at least 24 hours because of this medical emergency. I further certify that I am not receiving unemployment benefits or workers' compensation benefits in connection with this medical emergency for which I am requesting transferred annual leave.							
SIGNATURE OF RECIPIENT OR HIS OR HER DESIGNEE (please specify):						DATE	
☒ Recipient ☐ Designee <i>/s/ Johanna K. Moon</i>						5/2/9X	
CONCURRENCE:		SIGNATURE OF SUPERVISOR		TITLE		OFFICE TELEPHONE NO. DATE	
☒ Yes		<i>/s/ Mary Brown</i>		COS Head		814-447-4231 5/2/9X	
☐ No							
PART II - AGENCY REVIEW AND APPROVAL							
1. CURRENT ANNUAL LEAVE BALANCE (in hours)		2. CURRENT SICK LEAVE BALANCE (in hours)		3. LWOP HOURS USED IN CONJUNCTION WITH THIS EMERGENCY		4. ADVANCED SICK LEAVE HOURS TO DATE	
8		4		-0-		-0-	
						5. ADVANCED ANNUAL LEAVE HOURS TO DATE	
						-0-	
						6. ADVANCED LEAVE CATEGORY PER PAY PERIOD	
						4	
APPLICATION APPROVED: ☒ Yes (If Yes, transferred leave may be credited to the recipient's account effective Pay Period Number): 9 ☐ No (state reason for disapproval):							
SIGNATURE OF APPROVING OR DISAPPROVING OFFICIAL		TITLE		OFFICE TELEPHONE NO.		DATE	
<i>/s/ Donald Harley</i>		LTP Coordinator, PD		814-447-1010		5/4/9X	
PRIVACY ACT STATEMENT							
§ U.S.C. 6311 authorizes collection of this information. Your social security number may be disclosed to leave donors for the purpose of positively identifying leave recipients so that donated leave can be credited to the proper account.							
Electronic version designed using WordPerfect for Windows 6.0 (USDA-FSA)							